

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 897

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Rustin Jones on receiving the 2026 Social Studies School Service Civil Rights/Civil Liberties Excellence in Teaching Award.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those outstanding teachers who have devoted their careers to providing the highest-quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Rustin Jones is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished himself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Jones has been selected as the recipient of the 2026 Social Studies School Service Civil Rights/Civil Liberties Excellence in Teaching Award, a most befitting honor that recognizes the positive influence he has on so many young lives; and

WHEREAS, presented by the Tennessee Council for the Social Studies (TCSS), the award recognizes and honors the accomplishments of a social studies teacher in the area of civil rights and civil liberties; nominees inspire students to be fully informed about the civil rights and liberties assured by the U.S. Constitution; and

WHEREAS, Rustin Jones inspires students to take informed action when they see injustices and to be responsible, contributing members of our democracy; and

WHEREAS, currently, he teaches eighth-grade social studies and is the head coach for both boys' and girls' soccer teams at Greeneville Middle School; and

WHEREAS, an extremely talented and compassionate educator, Rustin Jones works assiduously to motivate his students to reach their full potential, both as scholars and as citizens; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Jones serves as an inspiration to his colleagues and students alike, and his friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know him; and

WHEREAS, Rustin Jones truly epitomizes the dedicated teacher who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and he should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Rustin Jones on receiving the 2026 Social Studies School Service Civil Rights/Civil Liberties Excellence in Teaching Award, commend his exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute his professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish him all the best in his future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.